

ClassPad: an interactive tablet for students

Classteacher Learning Systems has unveiled a new interactive tablet, the ClassPad, which runs on Android 2.2. The price ranges between Rs 7,500 and Rs 14,500. It is expected to give tough competition to the Aakash tablet in the educational sector. The newly launched tablet comes enabled with Web-based content for schools.

The tablet has been developed by Rohit Pande and Sameer Buti, IIT Delhi alumni and the co-founders of Mind Shaper Technologies. It has been designed for students from class 3-12. This interactive device supports high-end e-learning and a mobile library, and would be available in two models: the One Tablet Per Child (OTPC) for single students, and the Trolley Model for a group of students. Through this innovative device, teachers can transfer class work to the students' tablets, share their own content instantly, and conduct tests/assessments. ClassPad provides personalised teaching by categorising students as fast learners, average learners and slow learners, thus enhancing the learning experience through its unique artificial intelligence.

The schools that have tied up for the device in India include Father Agnel School, Delhi; SSB, Bangalore; and Centre Point School, Nagpur. The tablet is not yet available for retail sale.



Open source robotic surgery platform for top research labs

An open source robotic surgery platform has been developed, which will help the top medical labs across the United States. Robotics experts at the University of California and the University of Washington have developed a set of seven robotic surgery systems, which can be used by all major medical research labs in the United States. Five of the systems will be shipped to the Harvard University, Johns Hopkins University, University of Nebraska, UC Berkeley, and UCLA, while the remaining two systems will be retained at UC Santa Cruz and UW. All this will be done after a final round of tests.

Jacob Rosen, associate professor of computer engineering in the Baskin School of Engineering at UC Santa Cruz, and principal investigator on the project, said that they decided to choose an open source model because it would enable the field to advance more quickly if all the labs have a common research platform for doing robotic surgery.

Here comes Firefox 10 beta!

Mozilla has released the first public beta build of Firefox version 10.0. According to the developers of the browser, this version comes with Full Screen APIs, which enable the Web apps to run in full-screen mode, with support for CSS3 3D-Transforms and WebGL Anti-Aliasing, apart from an added HTML5 nudge: the < bdi > element for bi-directional text isolation.

This beta also comes with a forward button, which cannot be seen until you navigate back; an Inspector tool with content highlighting, IndexedDB APIs and a few fixes. It is available for Windows, Mac OS and Linux.



Android drivers returning to the Linux kernel

Kernel maintainer Greg Kroah-Hartman has put back the Android drivers into his development branch for version 3.3 of the Linux kernel.

The drivers were earlier removed from the staging area of Linux 2.6.33 in the spring of 2010. With this move, it will be possible for a Linux 3.3 kernel to boot on an Android device without further patches. Developers can also help in integrating Android patches into the mainline kernel by signing up for the project's mailing list.

BlueStacks creates 'Mr Android 2011'

BlueStacks, a company that enables Android applications to run on Windows machines, has come out with its first annual 'Mr Android' icon.



Employing data from Nielsen, as well as information culled this month from a poll of its 145,000 Facebook fans, BlueStacks created a composite Android user dubbed 'Mr Android 2011'. The data highlighted some interesting statistics: a full third of Android users have never downloaded a paid app; 37 per cent of polled Android users wear glasses; and 45 per cent wear one of those soon-to-be-obsolete wristwatches. BlueStacks also plans to come up with a 'Ms Android' in 2012. To catch a glimpse of Mr Android 2011, check out <http://bluestacks.com/mr-android-2011/>